

सद्गति (SADGATI)

एक अंतिम विनती

(Munshi Premchand की कहानी पर आधारित — मूल रूपांतरण)

Runtime target: ~20–22 minutes

Cast: 15

Set/Props: None required — see staging notes below

Staging Notes (rehearsal se pehle padhein)

- **Do zones, koi set change nahi:** Room ka ek side **SL** — Dukhi ka ghar / gaanv, doosra side **SR** — Pandit Ghasiram ka angan. Actors bas zone mein chal ke jaayein — audience turant samajh jaayegi.
- **Lighting board nahi hai? Koi baat nahi.** Har "blackout" ki jagah: sab actors stage par freeze ho jayein, nazrein neeche kar lein, aur 3 second ke liye bilkul hile nahi. Chhote room mein ye blackout jaisa hi kaam karta hai.
- **Sirf ek asli prop chahiye:** ek kulhaadi (koi bhi stick/danda). Baaki sab — thaali, lota, panchang, log ka tana — mime karein. Mime commit karke,

specific tarike se karein, vague nahi — tabhi convincing lagega.

- **Tension pace aur pauses mein hai, dialogue ki lambaai mein nahi.** Ye script jaan-boojh kar dialogue mein halki aur blocking mein bhaari hai. Khaamoshiyon ki utni hi rehearsal karein jitni lines ki — Scene 5 ki khaamoshi aur Scene 7 ka ant, dono asahaj (uncomfortable) lambe lagne chahiye. Wahi asahajta hi is play ka point hai.
- **Overlapping dialogue** jahaan bhi likha hai, wahaan actors ko ek-doesre ko halka sa cut karna sikhayein — real crowd jaisa lagna chahiye, ek-ek line ka wait nahi.

Cast List (15) — casting ke liye

1. **सूत्रधार (Sutradhar)** — Narrator; poori play mein aata-jaata rahta hai; ant mein baat seedhi audience se karta hai
2. **दुखी (Dukhi)** — mehnatkash, Chamar, garib par garima wala insaan
3. **झुरिया (Jhuria)** — Dukhi ki patni
4. **सावित्री (Savitri)** — unki beti, jiski shaadi ki baat chal rahi hai
5. **अम्मा (Amma)** — buzurg padosan, seedhi-saadi lekin teekhi

6. **बुद्धू (Buddhu)** – Dukhi ka dost, padosi
7. **सुखू (Sukhu)** – Buddhu ka chhota bhai
8. **पंडित घसीराम (Pandit Ghasiram)** – gaanv ke pujari,
bura nahi – bas andha
9. **पंडिताइन (Panditain)** – Ghasiram ki patni
10. **रामू (Ramu)** – unka chhota beta, abhi tak masoom
11. **नाई (Nai)** – gaanv ka nai, sabse pehle khabar
sabko pahunchata hai
12. **पंडित देविदास (Pandit Devidas)** – mehmaan
Brahmin, Ghasiram jaisi soch
13. **पंडित रामलाल (Pandit Ramlal)** – mehmaan
Brahmin, jiske andar zameer bacha hai
14. **ज़मींदार / ठाकुर साहब (Zamindar)** – gaanv ka malik,
taaqtwar aur udaseen
15. **गाँववाला / कोरस आवाज़ (Villager/Chorus)** – end
mein ikattha hone waali bheed ka hissa; extra
lines bhi le sakta hai

Har character ka stage-time saaf tarike se ek-do scenes mein bandha hai, taaki alag-alag actors apne hisse alag se rehearse kar sakein. Agar 15 se kam actors hain, to end mein doubling notes dekhein.

SCENE 1 – Prastavna (Center) – ~1 min

(SUTRADHAR akela, center stage mein aata hai.)

SUTRADHAR: Ek chhota sa gaanv. Ek chhota sa sawaal. Dukhi naam ke ek mehnatkash ne bas itna maanga tha — apni beti ki shaadi ke liye ek shubh tareekh. Bas itna. Dekhiye, ek chhoti si guzarish kaise, kisi ke liye sirf ek "kaam" ban jaati hai — aur kisi ke liye, sab kuch.

(Peeche hat jaata hai. Lights — ya focus — SL par shift.)

SCENE 2 — Ghar Par (SL) — ~3 min

(DUKHI baitha kuch theek kar raha hai. JHURIA khaana bana rahi hai. SAVITRI paas baithi hai. AMMA visit par aayi hui hai.)

AMMA: Suna hai, Savitri ke liye rishta aaya hai?

DUKHI: *(khush hoke)* Haan Amma-ji. Achha ghar hai, mehnati ladka hai. Bas Jhuria kehti hai, tareekh shubh honi chahiye.

JHURIA: *(bina dekhe)* Aur kyun nahi honi chahiye? Ek hi beti hai meri. Kal koi ye na kahe ki humne jaldbaazi mein kar diya.

SAVITRI: *(sharma kar)* Maa, itni bhi badi baat nahi hai...

(Sab haste hain. DUKHI SAVITRI ka sar sahlaata hai.)

DUKHI: Kal subah Pandit Ghasiram ke paas jaata hoon. Bas panchang dekh ke ek din bata denge. Ek ghante ka kaam hai.

BUDDHU: (*SUKHU ke saath andar aakar*) Dukhi bhai, kuch le jaana unke liye. Khaali haath jaana theek nahi lagta.

SUKHU: (*hasta hua*) Aur do baar jhukna, ek baar kaafi nahi hota unke liye.

DUKHI: (*hansta hua, par ek pal ki hichkichaahat*) Arre, Pandit hain, sher nahi. Apna kaam hai, unka apna. Bas itni si baat hai.

AMMA: (*dheere se, khud se*) Bas itni si baat hoti, to achhi baat thi, beta.

(*JHURIA DUKHI ke haath mein ek chhoti si potli deti hai.*)

JHURIA: Ye le jao. Aur jaldi aana.

DUKHI: (*muskura kar*) Suraj chadhne se pehle wapas, dekh lena.

(*Exit karta hai. JHURIA use jaate hue dekhti hai.*)

SCENE 3 — Angan Mein (SR) — ~4 min

(GHASIRAM stool par baitha hai. NAI unki dhaadi bana raha hai. PANDITAIN aas-paas kaam kar rahi hai. RAMU khel raha hai.)

NAI: *(gossip karte hue)* Aur suniye Pandit-ji, aaj Thakur Saheb khud gaanv mein aa rahe hain.

GHASIRAM: *(khush hoke)* Aane do. Mera angan hamesha saaf-suthra rehta hai. *(gate ke paas pade lattha (log) dekh kar, chidh kar)* Bas ye lattha ek mahine se pada hai, aankhon mein khataкта hai.

PANDITAIN: Teen baar keh chuki hoon, gate ke bilkul saamne pada hai.

(DUKHI angan ke bahar rukta hai, haath jodta hai.)

DUKHI: Pandit Maharaj — pranam. Bas itni si baat thi — meri beti ki shaadi ke liye ek shubh tareekh chahiye thi.

GHASIRAM: *(bina poora dekhe)* Haan haan, baitho, baitho. Dekhta hoon. *(lattha par nazar padte hi, jaise achanak yaad aaya ho)* Arre haan — Dukhi, ye lattha bhi kaat do zara. Tab tak main panchang dekh leta hoon. Do kaam, ek saath — kya baat hai!

DUKHI: *(hichkichaate hue)* Maharaj, subah se kuch khaya nahi hai maine —

GHASIRAM: *(halke se, dhyaan kahin aur)* Bas thodi der ka kaam hai. Tumhare jaise mazboot aadmi ke liye.

(DUKHI ek pal rukta hai – phir kulhaadi uthaa kar lattha ki taraf badhta hai. RAMU curious hoke paas aata hai.)

RAMU: Chacha, aap itni mehnat kyun kar rahe ho?
Baithiye na thoda.

DUKHI: *(muskura kar, kulhaadi rok kar)* Agar main baithoonga, beta, to ye kaam kaun karega? Tumhare papa intezaar kar rahe hain, aur meri beti ki shaadi bhi.

RAMU: Aapki beti ki shaadi ho rahi hai? Kaisi hai wo?

DUKHI: *(garmjoshi se)* Poore gaanv mein sabse achhi, beta. Chidiya ki tarah gaate hue kaam karti hai.

PANDITAIN: *(teekhe se)* Ramu! Andar aao, abhi!

(RAMU confuse hoke bhaag jaata hai. DUKHI ki muskaan halki si fiki padti hai. Kulhaadi ki awaaz shuru hoti hai – bhaari, laykaar. Lights halke se dim hote hain, waqt guzarne ka ishara.)

SCENE 4 – Mehmaan (SR) – ~3.5 min

(DUKHI abhi bhi kaam kar raha hai, dheere-dheere thakta hua. GHASIRAM ab do mehmaan ke saath baitha hai – PANDIT DEVIDAS aur PANDIT RAMLAL.)

DEVIDAS: *(Dukhi ki taraf ishara karte, seedha dekhe bina)* Achha kaam le rahe ho isse, Ghasiram bhai. Aise logon ko sakhti se hi rakhna padta hai.

GHASIRAM: *(khush)* Ye lattha ek mahine se pareshaan kar raha tha. Dopahar tak khatam ho jayega.

RAMLAL: *(Dukhi ko dhyaan se dekhte hue)* Kaafi der se kulhaadi chala raha hai. Kuch khaya hai isne aaj?

GHASIRAM: *(taalte hue)* Ghar jaake kha lega. Koi asambhav kaam thodi maanga hai maine.

RAMLAL: *(halke se, par baat rukti nahi)* Phir bhi. Bhare pet se aadmi behtar kaam karta hai. Ek waqt ka khana dene mein kya jaata hai —

DEVIDAS: *(hansta hua, baat kaat kar)* Ramlal, tum aur tumhara narm dil. Ab to keh doge ki sabko ek hi thaali mein khilao.

(Hansi. GHASIRAM aur DEVIDAS saath hasnte hain. RAMLAL nahi hasta — Dukhi ki taraf phir dekhta hai, pareshaan, par kuch kehta nahi. DUKHI dagmagaata hai.)

DUKHI: *(dheere se, khud se)* Bas itna hi... bas itna hi baaki hai...

(Seedha hota hai, seene par haath rakhta hai.)

DUKHI: *(kamzor awaaz mein)* Maharaj... thoda paani mil sakta hai?

GHASIRAM: *(uthe bina, halka sa ishara karte)* Kuaan wahaan hai. Haath se le lena, lota mat chhuna.

(DUKHI kuaan ki taraf badhta hai, wahaan tak pahunch nahi paata – tulsi ke paas baith jaata hai, saans phool rahi hai. RAMLAL uthne lagta hai, DEVIDAS uska haath pakad kar rok leta hai.)

DEVIDAS: *(dheere se)* Baitho. Hamara kaam nahi hai ye.

(DUKHI ek aakhri baar kulhaadi uthaata hai – chalaata hai – aur gir jaata hai. Kulhaadi zameen par girti hai. Ek pal ke liye sannata.)

SCENE 5 – Khamoshi (SR) – ~2 min

SANNAATA. 5–8 second tak asli khamoshi rakhein.
Koi hile nahi.

GHASIRAM: *(dhyaan se dekhe bina)* Dukhi? ... Ho gaya kya?

(Koi jawaab nahi. Ghasiram ek kadam aage badhta hai, phir ruk jaata hai – paas jaane se darta hai.)

GHASIRAM: *(tez awaaz mein)* Dukhi! *(pause)* ...Dukhi!

(PANDITAIN bahar aati hai, dekh kar peeche hat jaati hai. RAMLAL uthta hai, sabse zyada paas jaata hai.)

RAMLAL: *(ghutno ke bal baithte hue, chhoote bina)* Ye saans nahi le raha. Ghasiram — ye mar chuka hai.

(Bhayanak khaamoshi. GHASIRAM ka chehra dukh se nahi — hisaab-kitaab aur dar se tan jaata hai.)

GHASIRAM: *(peeche hatte hue)* Yahin... mere angan mein... tulsi ke bilkul paas...

DEVIDAS: *(wahi khauf, peeche hat kar)* Poore gaanv ko shaam tak pata chal jaayega. Kahenge ek Brahmin ke dwaar par ek Chamar mar gaya —

GHASIRAM: *(taham-taham karte hue)* Angan mein Ganga-jal chhidakna padega. Kuaan bhi. Tulsi chabutra bhi. Jahaan-jahaan ye chhoo gaya hoga —

RAMLAL: *(dheere se, par baat kaat deti hai)* Ye tumhare liye kaam karte-karte mara hai, Ghasiram. Khaali pet. Aur tumhe apne angan ki fikar hai?

(GHASIRAM ke paas iska koi jawaab nahi. Lights/focus dheere se hatte hain.)

SCENE 6 — Gaanv (SR se SL) — ~4 min

(SUTRADHAR ek pal ke liye aata hai.)

SUTRADHAR: Chhote gaanv mein khabar tez chalti hai. Shaam tak sabko pata tha — sirf ek ghar ko chhod kar, jo abhi bhi darwaaze par intezaar kar raha tha.

(SL par JHURIA, SAVITRI, AMMA khade hain. NAI aata hai, nazrein jhukaaye.)

JHURIA: *(Nai ka chehra dekh kar)* Tum us taraf se aa rahe ho. Dukhi ko dekha? Dopahar tak wapas aane wale the —

NAI: *(mushkil se)* Jhuria... kaise kahoon...

(JHURIA ka chehra badal jaata hai. SAVITRI maa ki baanh pakad leti hai.)

NAI: *(dheere se)* Dukhi... wo Pandit ke ghar lakdi kaatte-kaatte gir gaye. Wo... wo nahi rahe, Jhuria.

(Sannaata. JHURIA cheekhti nahi — bilkul sthir ho jaati hai, jo aur bhi bhayanak hai. SAVITRI chup-chaap rone lagti hai. AMMA use sambhaalti hai.)

JHURIA: *(bahut dheere)* Wo sirf ek tareekh puchne gaye the...

(BUDDHU aur SUKHU aate hain, gussa aur dukh dono chehron par.)

BUDDHU: *(gussa mein)* Sach hai kya — wo unhe piche ke darwaaze se, raat mein le jaana chahte hain? Jaise wo insaan hi na ho?

SUKHU: *(kadwa)* Aur Pandit-ji ussi jagah Ganga-jal chhidak rahe hain jahaan wo gire the. Jaise zameen ne dukh jhela ho, unhone nahi.

(JHURIA is baat par tez nazrein uthaati hai — dukh mein ek pal ke liye saaf soch aati hai.)

JHURIA: *(dheeme par mazboot awaaz mein)* Mere pati ne unhe apni subah di. Apni taaqat di. Apni aakhri saans di — aur unhe sirf apna angan dhona yaad hai.

(ZAMINDAR aata hai — jaldbaazi mein nahi, roz ke kaam jaisa, poora andaaz udaaseen.)

ZAMINDAR: *(kisi se khaas baat na karte hue)* Suna hai Ghasiram ke ghar ek Chamar mar gaya. Bura hua. *(BUDDHU se)* Dekh lena chupchaap nipat jaaye. Aisa hota rehta hai.

(Jaane lagta hai. RAMLAL, jo peeche-peeche aaya hai, aage badh kar seedha usse baat karta hai — poori play mein pehli baar koi taaqatwar insaan kuch challenge karta hai.)

RAMLAL: *(mazbooti se)* Thakur Saheb — maafi ke saath — ek aadmi mara hai. Bhookh aur mehnat se, ek Brahmin ke angan mein, sirf apni beti ke liye ek

tareekh maangte hue. Ye "chupchaap nipatne wali baat" nahi hai. Ye ek galti hai jo hui hai.

ZAMINDAR: *(halka sa ruk kar, chidh kar par bina asar liye)* Pandit-ji, ye purani riwaayatein hain. Hum-aap se bhi purani. *(exit)*

(RAMLAL use jaate hue dekhta hai, majboor mehsoos karta hai. Phir JHURIA ki taraf palat kar sar jhukaata hai — poori play mein pehli baar koi unche darje ka insaan use asli izzat deta hai.)

RAMLAL: *(dheere se, Jhuria se)* Mujhe maaf kar dijiye. Aapke pati ke saath jo hua, wo sahi nahi tha. Main ise bhoolunga nahi.

(Exit karta hai. JHURIA use jaate hue dekhti hai, phir apni beti ko gale lagaati hai. Focus dheere se JHURIA aur SAVITRI par simat jaata hai.)

SCENE 7 — Antim Baat (Center) — ~2 min

(Sab lights fade, sirf SUTRADHAR par focus. Baaki sab actors dheere se aakar peeche ek line mein khade ho jaate hain, audience ki taraf mooh karke — GHASIRAM aur DEVIDAS thoda alag, sar jhukaaye; RAMLAL, JHURIA, SAVITRI aage ki taraf.)

SUTRADHAR: Dukhi ne us subah bas ek cheez maangi thi — ek tareekh, ek calendar ka din. Badle mein usne apni mehnat di, apni bhookh di, aur aakhir mein apni jaan. Aur jis angan mein wo mara, wo shaam tak dho-poonch diya gaya. Lekin jo galti hui, wo kabhi nahi dhuli.

(Ek pal ruk kar.)

SUTRADHAR: Ye kahani kisi ek bure aadmi ki nahi hai. Ghasiram koi rakshas nahi tha — wo ek aam aadmi tha, apne mehmaanon ki, apne angan ki, apni izzat ki fikar karta hua. Yahi sabse khatarnak baat hai — wo zulm jo shor nahi machaata, jo "bas aisa hi hota hai" ke peeche chhup jaata hai.

(RAMLAL ki taraf dekhte hue.)

SUTRADHAR: Aur ye kahani umeed ke bina bhi nahi hai. Us angan mein ek insaan ne dekha. Jhuka. Bola — jab chup rehna sabse aasan tha. Har badlaav wahin se shuru hota hai — jab koi ek insaan, caste ya label se pehle, saamne khade insaan ko dekhta hai.

SUTRADHAR: *(seedha audience se)* Toh hum ek sawaal chhod kar jaate hain — jo Premchand ne sau saal pehle poocha tha, aur jiska jawaab hum aaj bhi dhoondh rahe hain: Jab koi aapke saamne khada ho, kuch maangte hue — sirf apna itna sa haq maangte hue — kya aap uska kaam dekhenge... ya use, ek insaan ki tarah?

(Ek lambi khaamoshi. Sab actors saath mein seedha audience ki taraf dekhte hain.)

SAB (saath mein, dheere se): Kya aap insaan ko dekhenge?

(Freeze. 3 second hold. Lights fade to black.)

END OF PLAY

Production Notes

Doubling (agar 15 se kam actors hain): NAI aur VILLAGER/CHORUS ek hi actor kar sakta hai (chhota costume change). SUKHU ki lines BUDDHU mein jod sakte hain — cast 13 tak aa jaayega. RAMU ke liye koi bhi chhoti umar ya kam anubhav wala actor theek rahega, lines kam hain.

Kulhaadi ki awaaz: Live drum/dholak (offstage) ya real stick se zameen par halki thaap — laykaar rakhein, phir dheere-dheere slow karein jab tak Dukhi gir na jaaye. Audience ko uski thakaan mehsoos honi chahiye, achanak surprise nahi.

Pandit Ramlal: Ye character Premchand ki asal kahani mein nahi hai — is version mein jode gaye hain taaki privileged group ke andar bhi zameer ka ek chehra ho, aur ensemble mein har actor ko meaningful stage-

time mile. Agar aapki strongest actor Scene 7 mein hai, to Ramlal ka reaction thoda aur bada kar sakte hain.

Aakhri choral line ("Kya aap insaan ko dekhenge?") optional hai — agar group ko chup ant zyada pasand ho, to SUTRADHAR ki akeli line ke baad seedha freeze/blackout bhi achha lagta hai. Dono rehearse karke dekhein, jo bhi group ke saath behtar lage.